

LT Ruud EDQP Board Questions

Contracts

- Talk about each type and their strengths and weaknesses
- Why would you use each type of contract
- When in your portfolio would you use a firm fixed price contract
- For FFP where can this cause a problem?
- What else can a contractor do if they think cost is no longer in their favor under a FFP type contract
 - What can the contractor do legally if something makes them take on more cost than planned: Request for Equitable Adjustment (REA) set up to address things that were not foreseen
 - What is the contractor saying when they send a REA
- Award fee at NRO from a govt view vs vendor view what is an AF from a contractor perspective
- What is the contract of benefiting relative to all contracts
- LOE CPFF contract what does the contractor have to deliver and what do they get
- When would you use CPFF vs CPIF vs FFP
- For award fee when and how often will you do boards
- If I have known scope of work and I know a contractor would do it which contract type would you use
- What recourse does the contractor have if they don't agree with the AF?
- What happens if the gov't gives a \$0 AF?
- Where is the burden of work on gov't for IF vs AF?

Horseblanket/Testing

- Lay out L/C and where you might use these contracts
- What do you need to get into M/S A
- What does it mean to get a M/S C decision
 - What are you asking the MDA for at M/S C
 - What are the entry and exit criteria for M/S C
- What happens in LRIP
- Do you start testing after M/S C
- Draw a curve to show where money lies, amount and listing type of appropriation
- Money used for a tech refresh IT capability
- What happens to get you to IOC
 - How do you accomplish operational testing

- What are KPPs and KSAs and what makes those different from other requirements
- Can there be a reason why you can't meet them?
- ACAT levels and who are the MDAs can this be delegated
- Who creates the KPP
- What are you trying to get out of operational test?
 - What does OT prove
- Who creates the ICD
- Who is DOT&E and why was it stood up and who do they report to
- What types of contracts are used in each phase and why?
- When does a program become a POR?
- What are the types of money you can use for upgrades/mods?
- What are the various test organizations what do they do?
- Is there a reason why you may not meet a KPP/KSA and need relief?
- Who do you submit a KPP/KSA waiver to?
- Who are typical MDAs?
- How far down can MDA responsibilities be delegated? What is normal?
- What are the two key determinations that come out of OT?

Command Organizations

- How would you go about facilitating organizational change
- Draw out OPNAV(N codes and down a level) and all the SYSCOMs
 - Draw out the organization of one of the SYSCOMs
- In IWS 6.0 who do I have to talk to in NAVSEA and OPNAV
- how is maintenance done on ships vs program level
- if an RMC is unable to do repair who is the next level of support for the RMC?
- Map and drawing out the different fleet assets and their product lines
- What do the warfare centers do (name and list out focus areas)
- EDO ADMs who are the 3 stars
- What is unique about the warfare centers
- What are the challenges of increasing rates
- Who are the customers of the warfare centers
- Who does the PM go to if they need more money to pay bills
- What is going back to ask for more money called
- Who can the pm go to, to say he is going to overrun (called cost to complete)
- Where are the ISEAs located?
- What happens if warfare centers raise rates too much?

CIVPERS

- Who are the organizations you can reach out to for civilian personnel management issues
- Unions in our Government organization
- Is everyone part of the union
- What does a union get you / benefits
- What are the Douglas factors? How many?
- What can civilians file if they are unhappy with you
- Inspector generals what do they do
- How does it work between organizations
- As a leader what are some things you need to be sensitive to or keep into considerations, behaviors you might want to emulate
- What is the board that handles civilian complaints?
- Describe the grievance process
- What are some things you seen from leaders that you would like to emulate?

PPBE

- Explain PPBE
- Where are we now in the cycle
- What does CR mean what can you not do
- If you wanted to start a new program during a CR what/who do you submit

Current Events

- What are some current discussions/changes being discussed at the Pentagon
 - Key point here – they let you talk about whatever you want. You drive this part. If you don't have anything, things get awkward cause they start throwing topics at you.
- EDO community discussions on organizational level
- What is a DRPM?
 - What is unique about them
 - Who is Overmatch
- What is a PAE
- Where do you see as a community where the focus is
- CNO Changes to OPNAV
 - Why would accountability be such a big deal

- How do you drive accountability into a system

Lessons Learned

- Avoid answering questions with, “how we do it here”. This is one tour on a long EDO journey. You need to know how the Navy does things. The CAPTs may have no NRO experience so your answer will look weak.
- When you get asked a direct question, answer directly then use that to transition into a scripted topic. You should have about a dozen topics you could talk on for 5-10 minutes minimum. If you don’t know what they are asking, say so. If you don’t know the answer, say so.
- Know what your board CAPTs do. Know who they report to. Know who they interface with. Do your research and figure out what their days look like and where their pain is. What is their mission and vision? Are they accomplishing that? Don’t be afraid to ask them these questions while prepping for your board. Understand how their program is being impacted by big Navy/DOW/POTUS direction.
- Write large enough on the board for everyone at the table to read your writing. Don’t make the board members squint. Have a strategy for how you will present the information. Your drawings and lists should be neat and clear. Text should be level, not going downhill. Practice!
- When asked a question, don’t say the first thing that pops into your head just to fill the silence. Its ok to have a couple seconds of silence while you compose an answer. Don’t be afraid of silence. Its also ok to write down a complicated question to ensure you understand what they asked.
- A funny/joke response doesn’t land well. Stay composed and save the jokes for after the board.

Alex Murder Board Questions

Topics Covered During Board:

- Fleet maintenance
- Mission funding vs Navy working capital fund
- Horse blanket
- Describe JCIDS process
- PPBE
- EVM
- System V

Look ups:

- ❖ Other important functions of RMCs (other than I level)
They answer they were looking for was CNO Avails.
RMCs provide I-Level support, Fleet Technical Assistance (onsite and distance support), some D-level repair work, assessments (total Ship Readiness Assessments), underwater ship husbandry diver support, ISEA support, calibration support, etc.
- ❖ C4I 740?
International C4I Integration
- ❖ Who is the ASN (RD&A)
Currently: Incumbent Nickolas Guertin since December 20, 2023
The ASN (RD&A) organization is responsible for the development and acquisition of Navy and Marine Corps platforms and weapon systems.
- ❖ In PPBE what NSS stood for?
The National Security Strategy (NSS) is a report mandated by Section 603 of the Goldwater-Nichols Department of Defense Reorganization Act of 1986 (Public Law 99-433). The NSS has been transmitted annually since 1987, but frequently reports come in late or not at all. The NSS is to be sent from the President to Congress in order to communicate the executive branch's national security vision to the legislative branch. The NSS provides discussion on proposed uses of all facets of U.S. power needed to achieve the nation's security goals. The report is obligated to include a discussion of the United States' international interests, commitments, objectives, and policies, along with defense capabilities necessary to deter threats and implement U.S. security plans.
- ❖ Expend vs outlay
Expenditure – Charge against available funds. It results from a voucher, claim, or other document approved by competent authority
Outlay – Occurs when the vendor cashes the expenditure check and money flows from the Treasury to the vendor or supplier
- ❖ How does rework get paid for with a NWCF?
It is billed back to the customer. Work must be paid for.

- ❖ How is PMW 160 funded what type of funding
Mission funded through PPBE. Example of program CANES which would be OPN funds.
- ❖ What rate could you use to project costs from a warfare center
Stabilized Labor Rates



Stabilized Labor Rates

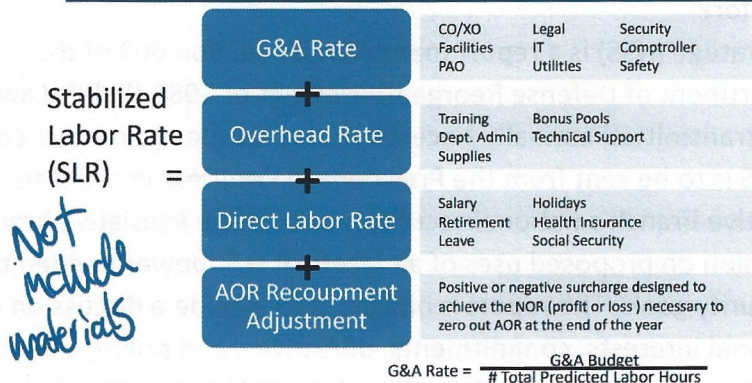
- Stabilized Labor Rates (SLR)
 - Charged to customers to reimburse a **NWCF** activity for work performed
 - Required to be established during the budget process at levels estimated to recover:
 - Budgeted costs of goods or services to be provided including all G&A overhead costs
 - Prior period gains and losses
 - Approved surcharges for capital assets acquisition
- The budget process is the mechanism used to ensure adequate resources are budgeted in the customer's appropriated fund accounts to pay the established rates and prices
- Provides budget stability to customers

$$\frac{(\text{Direct labor \$} + \text{Overhead \$} + \text{AOR recoup \$})}{\text{Direct hours}}$$

- ❖ Stabilized labor rates- how are they calculated



Stabilized Labor Rate Computation



SLR consists of (1) direct labor, (2) all indirect expenses, (3) AOR recoupment

- ❖ Documents you bring for FRP- Full rate production/milestones?
The PM would bring all documents that have been developed for the program to the FRP milestone. The most important/newest documents to be reviewed at this milestone are the test results from OT&E however, all documents will be brought for reference and review by the MDA.

- ❖ Who at the Pentagon helps you with requirements? Resource Sponsor?
Requirements Officers at the Pentagon along with Resource Sponsors
- ❖ What are the different types of cost estimates? Independent cost estimate, life cycle cost estimate?

Cost estimates: Must be developed before the execution phase begins and must be updated annually. There are four types of cost estimation:

- Analog – Draws a direct comparison between the program being estimated and a similar, completed program
- Parametric – Applies regression analysis to a database of several similar systems to develop cost estimating relationships (CERs)
- Engineering Build-up – Derived by summing detailed cost estimates of the individual work packages and adding appropriate burdens – Most commonly used for software estimates if data exists
- Actual – Extrapolates future estimated costs from actual costs, similar to analogy but based on data from the same program

- ❖ Difference between should cost/ will cost

Will Cost: Your funded-to level or what the program will cost without implementing additional cost saving management initiatives

Should Cost: The desired cost of the program after realizing cost savings due to successful implementation of management initiatives

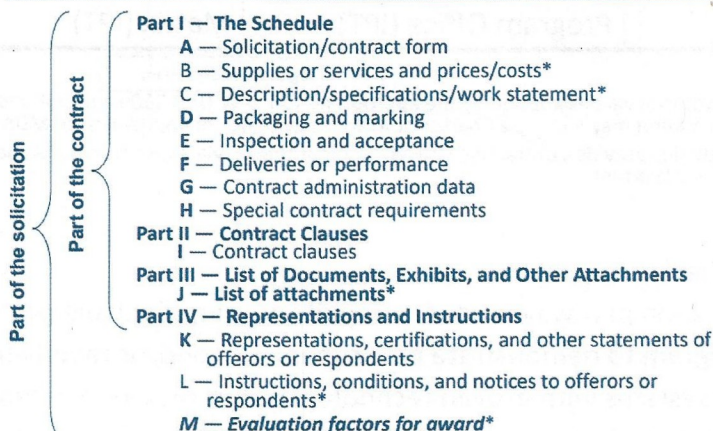
Will Cost – Management Initiatives = Should Cost

- ❖ What is in a proposal? How is it evaluated?

Proposal is written in the Uniform Contract Format (UCF). It is composed of 4 parts. Part I: The schedule, Part II: Contract Clauses, Part III List of Documents, Exhibits, and Other Attachments, Part IV: Representations and Instructions. It is evaluated based on the evaluation factors defined in section M.



Uniform Contract Format (UCF) for RFP



❖ Who can direct the contractor to do work?

This is a poorly worded questions. The answer they are technically looking for is KO. Below is the textbook definitions of KOs and PMs.

PMs & KOs have complementary roles & responsibilities and maintain a partnership throughout the acquisition process.

- KO's responsibilities: – Ensure contract performance & compliance – Serve as the contract advisor for the program - KO's major functions are to: – Prepare solicitations and contracts – Communicate with potential offers and negotiate contracts – Ensure consistency with the FAR and DFARS – Award contracts and any modifications, administer contracts, and terminate contracts – Legally bind the Government
- Program Manager (PM) responsibilities: – Responsible for managing the program (overall program responsibility) – Accountable to the Milestone Decision Authority (MDA) for cost, schedule, and performance in accordance with the DoD 5000 series



Differences between the Program Manager & the Contracting Officer

	Program Manager Cost, Schedule and Performance	Contracting Officer Contract Advisor
Authority	Tenure Agreement*	Warrant**
Responsibility	Entire program	Contract
Background/Training	Technical	Business
Guiding Directives	DoD 5000 Series	FAR System Contract management
Organization	Program Office (IPT)	Matrix (IPT)

IPT – Integrated Product Team

* PM's are provided their authority via designation by the appropriate CAE IAW DoD 5000 and DoD Instruction 5000.66 (additional documentation may include a Charter or ADM, as evidence of approval from MDA)

** Heads of Contracting Activities provide Contracting Officer's their authority via a Certificate of Appointment, SF 1402, commonly known as a Warrant

❖ Rapid Acquisitions

DoDI 5000.80 – Middle Tier of Acquisitions

The Middle Tier of Acquisition pathway is used to rapidly develop fieldable prototypes within an acquisition program to demonstrate new capabilities and/or rapidly field production quantities of systems with proven technologies that require minimal development. The MTA pathway is intended to fill a gap in the Defense Acquisition System

or even the Office of Inspector General for large/very serious issues involving fraud or waste. Other tools/resources could include SAPR or security.

- At the time of year your board is occurring what do you think ADMs on your board would be worried about?

My board is occurring at the beginning of September, so the biggest item on everyone's mind would be is the FY25 budget going to be passed on time? Need for preparation of operating in a continuing resolution. Since Presidential elections are this year preparing for the budget to potentially be delayed longer than typically seen.

- EDO leadership development framework?

Different tools/organizations within the EDO community to develop leadership. The key item would of course be the EDO mentoring sessions. Others include the book club, the GRGB meeting sessions, the Wardroom Podcast, etc.

The purpose of EDO LDF is:

- Community strategy to develop leaders up to Major Command or its equivalent
- ED School has lead – Flag Lead: RADM Small
- Follows CNO Guidance
- Incorporates mentoring policy
- Aligns development continuum (character, competence & connections) with leadership attributes and notional career path

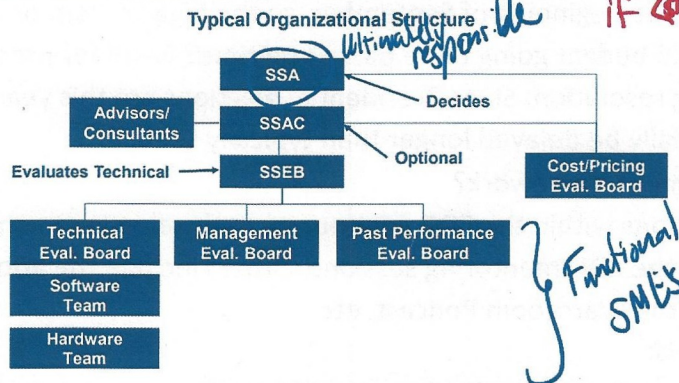
Examples include:

- Quarterly Community-wide book club – Run by Mentor Groups – Announced via EDO Main and TEAMS
 - EDO LDF Podcast (The Wardroom) – Leadership perspectives and questions answered from community leadership – Listen on Apple Podcasts, Spotify, Google Podcasts and more
 - Linked-In EDO Leader Development Network – Widely-available, low barrier to entry environment for communicating leader development topics and opportunities
 - Leverage NAVSEA sponsored Linked-In Learning accounts – Available to all EDO or via your local library – Hundreds of topics available that align to personal and professional development – Linked-In account Not required
 - Continuous Learning Seminars (CLS) – Run by Mentor Groups – Guidance/Standard Operating Procedures on EDO Main
- EDO news? Current events?

- Who is on the evaluation board?



Source Selection Organization



Source Selection Authority (SSA) is responsible for:

- Overseeing and ensuring the integrity of the source selection process
- Ensuring that qualified personnel are appointed to the SSEB and the SSAC
- Selecting the source(s) whose proposal is the best value to the Government

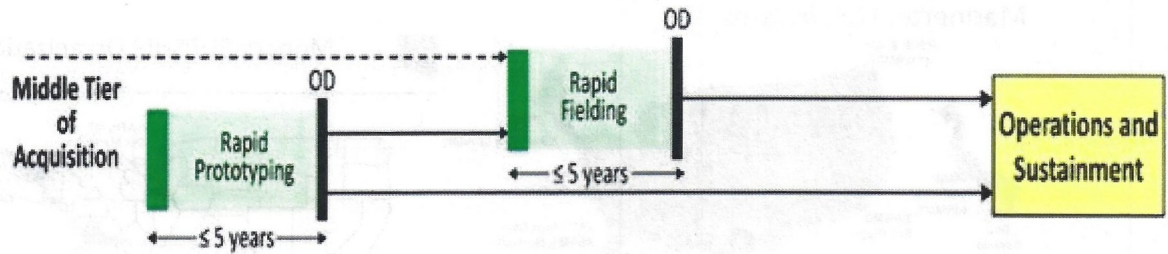
Source Selection Evaluation Board (SSEB) is:

- Comprised of various panels based on requirements:
 - Technical Evaluation Board (TEB)
 - Cost / Pricing Evaluation Board (CPEB)
 - Others as needed
- Evaluates proposals against the requirements in the RFP
 - Against a rating standard (for each evaluation criteria)
 - Qualitative or quantitative
- Identifies and documents:
 - Strengths
 - Weaknesses
 - Significant weaknesses
 - Deficiencies

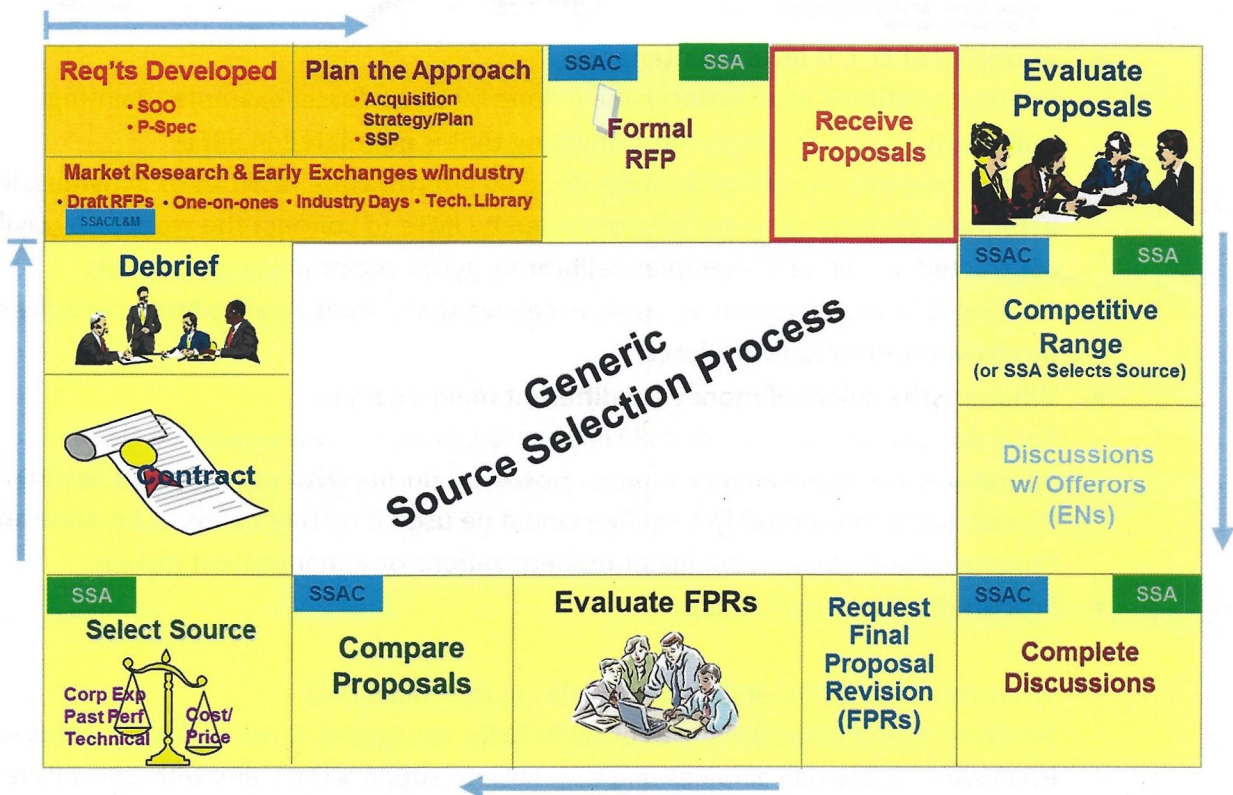
- What tools do you have to deal with troublesome civilian personnel?

Depends are the type of employee they are. Are they government civilian or government contractor? Regardless you always want to ensure that you are criticize in private. You also want to ensure that you first Contact Employee Relations (ER) before issuing disciplinary action to ensure it is appropriate and legally sufficient (informal, formal, and adverse). You should may also need to inform the civilian's parent agency chain of command. Other key tools/resources that you many need to reach out to include, HR (NRO EEO), the employee's Union Rep (if they are a part of a Union), an ombudsman (inquiry theme process), a grievance officer (help with conflict resolution),

(DAS) for those capabilities that have a level of maturity to allow them to be rapidly prototyped within an acquisition program or fielded, within 5 years of MTA program start. The MTA pathway may be used to accelerate capability maturation before transitioning to another acquisition pathway or may be used to minimally develop a capability before rapidly fielding. The rapid prototyping path provides for the use of innovative technologies to rapidly develop fieldable prototypes to demonstrate new capabilities and meet emerging military needs. The rapid fielding path provides for the use of proven technologies to field production quantities of new or upgraded systems with minimal development required.



❖ Source Selection process overview



Questions:

- Private shipyards and what platforms are at each- labeled private and public shipyards and RMCs on map

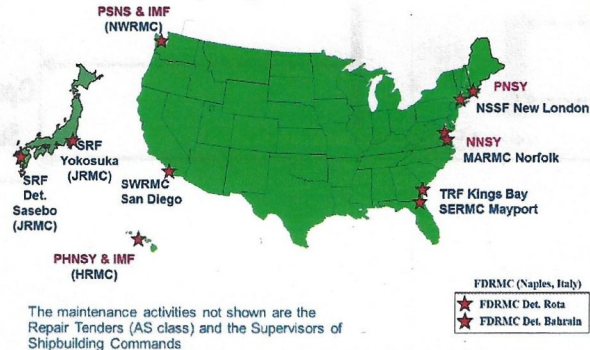
Bath Iron Works: destroyer, cruisers, weapons work

Electric Boat: Subs

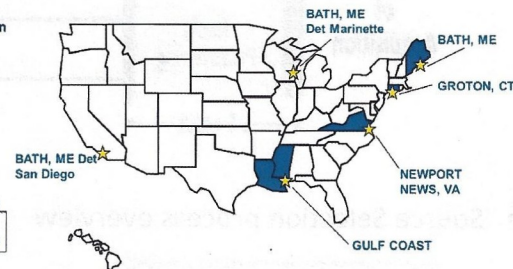
Newport News: CVNs, nuclear work

Gulf Coast: destroyer, cruisers, amphibis

Marinette: LCS, frigates



Modern SUPSHIP Organization



- Examples of O, I, D level maintenance
 - O – organizational level maintenance; done by ship's force; examples painting bulkheads, changing filters, most anything that is populated in SKED
 - I – intermediate level maintenance; done by intermediate facilities or activities, RMCs; actual work can be done by Sailors trained by IMFs to conduct the work or by civilian contracted individuals; examples calibrating gyros, maintaining gun barrels
 - D – Depot level maintenance; large, excessive work, think Availabilities; typically done by civilian contracted workforce.
- What are the colors of money for different maintenance?

For maintenance you are typically in you O&S phase so you would use O&M – operations and maintenance money. However, during O&S you may also use RDT&E or Procurement money. RDT&E money would be used if testing needs to be done and Procurement if you are looking at modernizations or enhancement installs.
- Procurement money for ships?

SCN
- What role does NIWC and NAVWAR play in the shipyards?

NAVWAR 5.0 CHENG, NIWC can provide SMEs to support TA work. Directorates within NAVWAR can provide services and expertise to support the ships with C4I systems. Ship visits, installs, CNO Avails.

NIWCs are to be the Navy's full spectrum research, development, test and evaluation (RDT&E), engineering, and fleet support centers for platforms, vehicles, systems and facilities associated with a particular warfare area.

Roles of the Warfare Centers include:

 - To make naval technical programs successful

- Provide technical advice and engineering leadership
 - To help determine and develop the capabilities that the Navy and Marine Corps need
 - As Government's trusted technical advisors, assist leadership in decision making
 - To verify the quality, safety, and effectiveness of platforms and systems
 - Exercise technical authority through rigorous systems engineering processes to promote the safety and effectiveness of our ships and systems
 - To help design, develop, and field solutions for urgent operational fleet needs
 - Able to deliver an array of responsive options and services for warfighter needs
 - To provide a bridge between warfighters and the technical community
 - Translate warfighter needs into technical requirements
- Who does C4I installs or modernizations?
NAVWAR - NAVWAR 4.0 does installs and modernizations.
- PEOs in NAVWAR and where are they located
PEO Digital – Washington Navy Yard, D.C.
PEO MLB – Washington Navy Yard, D.C.
PEO C4I – San Diego, CA
- Who do PEOs report to?
ASN (RD&A)
- What else do we use PPBE for?
PPBE is also used for resource allocation and the Future Year Defense Program (FYDP). The Resource Allocation Process (RAP) shows relationships between different PPBE cycles and phases, it is a useful tool to identify "time now" in order to understand the parameters at play when addressing funding challenges. FYDP's primary purpose is to track DoD funds, force structure, and personnel strength throughout the PPBE process. It is the DoD's internal database that is used to track the department's resource allocations. The DoN's access-controlled database is the Navy Program Budget Information System (PBIS). The FYDP projects DOD funding, manpower, and force structure needs over a five-year period. FYDP contains Prior Year (PY), Current Year (CY), Budget Year (BY) + 4 Out-Years (POM) + additional years for force structure only. It is a "living" record updated during the PPBE process.
- How does funding work for individual programs?
Went through PPBE for this question. Drew out POM process:
PMW -> PEO -> Resource Sponsor -> N8 -> SECNAV [DoN POM] -> DoD POM
- Who in OSD reviews the POM
OSD CAPE: Office Secretary of Defense: Cost Assessment & Program Evaluation

- If you are a PM and are underrunning how is that seen?
Underrunning means not spending as much as anticipated. This could potentially be seen as negative. Questions of why you are not spending as much could arise. You may be questioned are you behind schedule, did you over budget, if so why? When a program is underrunning it typically needs to find a way to spend the money because if it doesn't it could be targeted for repurposing of funds and potentially not receive as much funding the following year. As the PM on an underrunning program you may want to look for ways to expend the funds such as moving testing up or authorizing program enhancements.
- How does your underrun influence your future budget?
Your program could receive less funding in future years if you are underrunning and it could be targeted for repurposing of funds.
- How does NIWC support CANES?
The NIWC would support a program such as CANES by doing the installs and providing reach back support. Reach back support could come in the form of T&E should any further be needed and troubleshooting based on anomalies from install or operations.
- What are the groups called to do that support from NIWC?
Engineering Agents
The five types of Engineering Agents are:
 - 1) Technical Direction Agent (TDA)
 - 2) Design Agent (DA)
 - 3) System Integration Agent (SIA)
 - 4) Acquisition Engineering Agent (AEA)
 - 5) In-Service Engineering Agent (ISEA)

ISEAs: Responsibilities: – Support/provide life-cycle maintenance – Recommend to system manager corrections to deficiencies in all areas of life1cycle support – Manage configuration of equipment – Provide engineering assistance to the Fleet
- Would you budget for paying warfare centers?
If you know the work is forth coming then you should absolutely budget for it.
- Who makes the decision to enter different milestones?
Whoever the Milestone Decision Authority is, based on Acquisition Categories.
Acquisition Categories define the acquisition in terms of monetary value and who the Decision Authority is:

CAT1: major systems, RDT&E \$480M, PRO \$2.79B, DA is USD(A&S)

CAT2: RDT&E \$185M, PRO \$835M, DA is ASN(RD&A)

CAT3: no fiscal criteria DA is PM, SYSCOM, IAW component policy

CAT4: Navy systems, DA is PM, SYSCOM
- KSA vs KPP?
KPPs: Key Performance Parameters. Critical or essential attributes of a system.
Mandatory KPPs: Force Protection, System Survivability, Sustainment, and Energy.
KSAs: Key System Attribute: characteristics considered essential to achieving a balanced

solution/approach but not critical to be designated KPP. KSAs must be measurable, testable, and quantifiable. Mandatory KSAs: Availability, Reliability, Total Ownership Cost.

- What happens if you don't meet a KPP
Depends on where you are at in the cycle; need to assess whether or not the program has time to go back and do design work and assess why it wasn't met. Where there issues with testing or was the KPP truly not valid? If unable to meet KPP you will need a waiver provided by the JROC. The JROC ultimately determines if the KPP is not valid.
- Objectives vs thresholds of KPPs
Thresholds – minimum requirement
Objective – desired/maximum requirement
- Who oversees and who conducts DT+E and what does it tell you
Developmental Test and Evaluation (DT&E) – Conducted throughout the acquisition process to assist in engineering design and development – Used to verify component and system technical performance specifications have been met – Controlled by Government PMO – Performed by Government labs (e.g., NSWC) and/or Contractor teams – Helps identify & control design technical risk – Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense (DASD) DT&E may oversee
- What are you looking for in IOT+E and LFT+E and who conducts/who oversees?
OT&E is controlled by the operational test agency which is the COTF for the Navy. The actual tests are performed by warfighters in operational environments.
IOT&E – Initial Operational T&E – Statutorily required – Conducted on production-representative test articles – Prior to Full Rate Production decision – Validates production system meets operational requirements – COTF makes a determination of operational effectiveness and operational suitability
LFT&E – Live Fire T&E – Demonstrate lethality & survivability
- How do you engage with industry?
You engage with industry in a variety of ways. One of the most common forms of engagement would be through industry days. This is where contractors/businesses are invited to come and share their expertise, experiences, technology, and ongoing projects with the government so we can get an idea of what capabilities they have. Other ways to engage with industry include requests for information and releasing draft RFPs.
- Different types of contracts for each phase.
Technically, you can have any form of contract at any stage. Your KO will provide you with the best form for where you are at. However, utilizing MCA DoD horse blanket you most often see fixed price at MSA, P&D, and O&S, while you see cost reimbursable at TMRR and EMD.
- Difference between validation and verification
Verification: testing the functionality requirements, does it perform its intended functions and meet all performance requirements

Validation: does it work in the intended environment; consists of evaluating operational effectiveness, operational suitability, sustainability, and survivability

- Explain (EVM) earned value management

Tool for assessing budget and schedule performance. Helps to 1) establish performance standards for federal budget expenditures, 2) monitor, control, & report the contract and/or project performance, and 3) emphasize planning and integration of cost, schedule, and performance.

- What type of contracts require EVM? Why not FFP?

EVM is used on cost and incentive contracts, when the nature of the work is discretely measurable. It is required for contracts greater than \$20M and on contracts greater than \$100M validation is required by the DCMA (Defense Contract Management Agency).

- When are you doing market research?

Market research should be on going throughout the entire acquisition process. You always want to ensure that you have the most up to date market information.

Conducted throughout the acquisition life-cycle - Assist in development of the acquisition strategy and any related acquisition planning - Involves evaluating the potential of the commercial marketplace to meet system performance requirements - Used to: - Determine if sufficient sources exist and/or if commercial items are available to meet the requirement and to assist in performing price analysis - Extent varies depending upon factors such as urgency, estimated dollar value, complexity, and past experience - Done in an Integrated Product Team (IPT) environment

- Which section of the UCF used in evaluation criteria?

Section M - Evaluation Factors for Award - All significant factors that will be used to evaluate the proposals must be identified in Section M - The relative importance of the evaluation factors must be stated (listing them in descending order of importance) - Evaluation factors used in a solicitation depend on the requirement - Some evaluation factors could include: Price or cost, Past performance, Technical excellence, Management capability, Personnel qualifications, Prior experience, and Schedule compliance.

- Who on the team can communicate with the contractors?

This is a poorly worded question but the answer they are looking for is during solicitation and negotiations only the KO can communicate with the contractor.

KO's responsibilities: - Ensure contract performance & compliance - Serve as the contract advisor for the program - KO's major functions are to: - Prepare solicitations and contracts - Communicate with potential offers and negotiate contracts - Ensure consistency with the FAR and DFARS - Award contracts and any modifications, administer contracts, and terminate contracts - Legally bind the Government